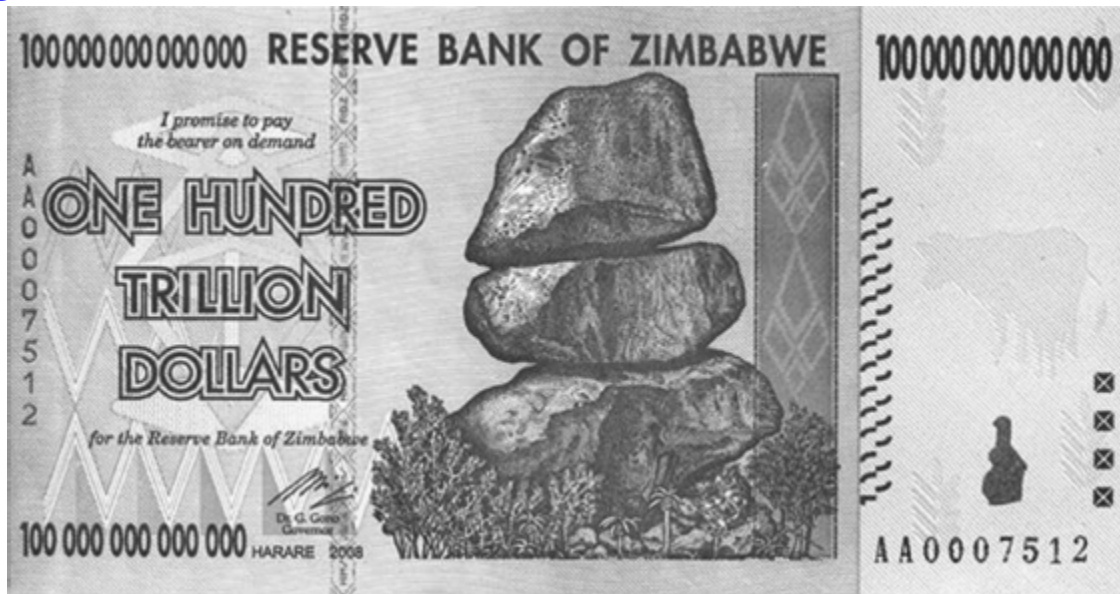


Figure 7.1 \$100 Trillion Zimbabwe Bill



You can imagine what happened to people who kept all their wealth in Zim dollars! An overseas account gives you some protection—against predatory governments, against incompetent monetary systems, against financial catastrophes, and against taxes.

There's nothing underhanded, illegal, immoral, or even shady about using offshore, foreign currency accounts. No need to lie about it, either. You can use accounts in tax havens legitimately to hold and invest wealth. Wealthy families typically do.

Remember, your family's wealth depends on two variables: its net (of costs/taxes) return per year and the number of years it continues. Taxes are the main cost. They need to be reduced so that your net rate of return will remain high. That is why one of your hard structures will ideally be located in a tax haven. Ideally, you will have a bank or investment firm that you trust—with someone you know you can work with, with an unassailable reputation and an unleveraged balance sheet, and low fees. This is not going to be easy to find. Few institutions will match that description. And the best of them won't want you for a customer.